

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

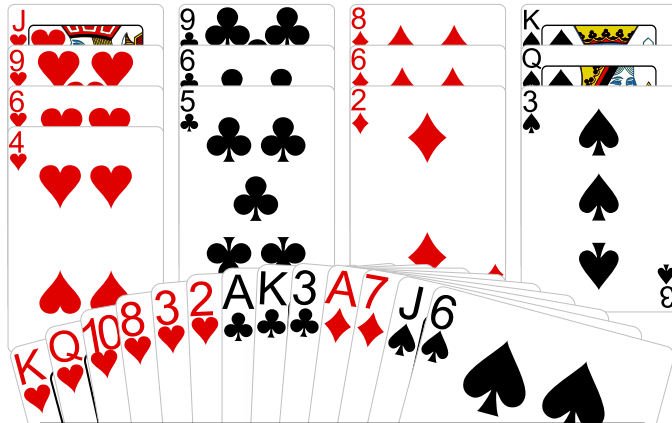
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



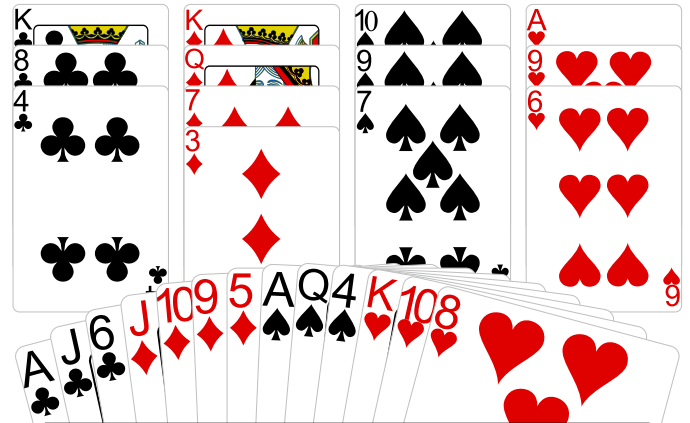
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



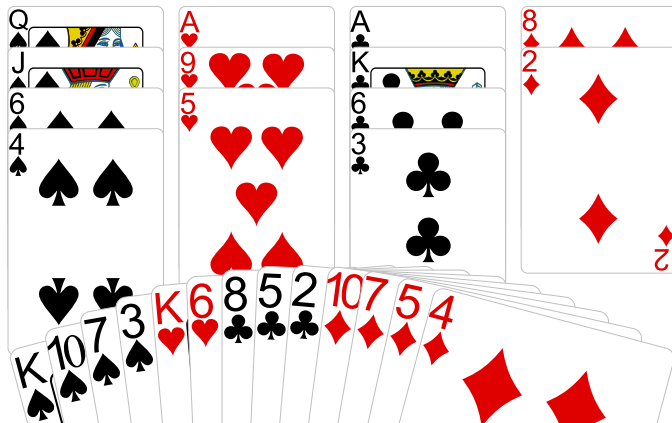
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



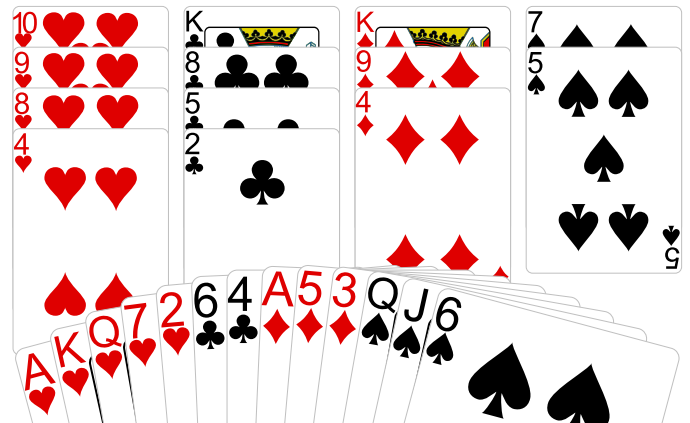
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 4 Ctr: 3♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2♠
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3♥
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A T 9 4
♥ A 5
♦ J 9 4 3
♣ T 7 4

17
9 8
6

♠ J 6
♥ K Q T 8 3 2
♦ A 7
♣ A K 3



♠ K Q 3
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 9 6 5

♠ 8 7 5 2
♥ 7
♦ K Q T 5
♣ Q J 8 2

West

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

North

1♥

4♥

East

Pass

South

2♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 1

SOUTH's 2



raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4



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Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ T 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

8
12 15
5

♠ J 6 5 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ A 2
♣ T 9 3



♠ K 8 3
♥ 7 4 3
♦ 8 6 4
♣ Q 7 5 2

♠ A Q 4
♥ K T 8
♦ J T 9 5
♣ A J 6

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 2

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening -

15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game

but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 5 2
♥ Q J T
♦ Q 9 6 3
♣ Q 9

14
11 9
6

♠ Q J 6 4
♥ A 9 5
♦ 8 2
♣ A K 6 3



♠ K T 7 3
♥ K 6
♦ T 7 5 4
♣ 8 5 2

♠ 8
♥ 8 7 4 3 2
♦ A K J
♣ J T 7 4

West

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by South

North

1♣

2♠

East

Pass

South

1♠

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 3

With 6 points, SOUTH must respond to NORTH's 1♣ opening bid.

While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", SOUTH should

skip over the weak



suit in favor of showing the 4-card

Major ♠ suit.

NORTH knows that SOUTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the

suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2♠.

With his minimum response hand SOUTH passes.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 6
♥ A K Q 7 2
♦ A 5 3
♣ 6 4

10
16 6
8

♠ A K 8 4 3

♥ J 5 3

♦ J 7 2

♣ J 9



♠ T 9 2

♥ 6

♦ Q T 8 6

♣ A Q T 7 3

♠ 7 5
♥ T 9 8 4
♦ K 9 4
♣ K 8 5 2

West

1 ♥

3 ♥

All Pass

3 ♥ by West

North

Pass

East

2 ♥

South

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 4

With 17 points WEST is not strong enough to insist on game after EAST's raise,

but is strong enough to invite with a 3



bid.

EAST, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 7
♥ A 7 5 2
♦ T 8 3
♣ T 4 3 2

17
5 9
9

♠ A 8 3 2
♥ K T 9
♦ A J 7
♣ K Q 6



♠ T 9 4
♥ Q J 4
♦ K Q 5 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K Q 6 5
♥ 8 6 3
♦ 9 6 4
♣ A 8 7

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 5

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution.

SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT.

NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.